



◀ **INTERNAL HDDs:**
**WESTERN DIGITAL
VELOCIRAPTOR 1 TB**
Price: ₹15,499

Internal HDDs

After the insane sky-rocketing of internal HDD prices last year, due to the Thailand floods, the prices seems to be coming down. But expecting to get HDDs at pre-floods prices isn't practical.

Zero1 Winner

Western Digital Velociraptor 1 TB

Just like last year, the WD Velociraptor has bagged the Zero1 Award this year as well. This time the capacity has been upgraded to 1 TB. It sports a 10,000 RPM drive with a 64 MB of cache buffer. It also comes with a 5-year warranty. Sequential Read/Write in MB/s: 199 / 190 and Assorted Read/Write in MB/s: 170 / 133. Need we say more for those looking at a blazing fast internal hard drive? This is the drive to buy.

Worthy Mentions

Hitachi Deskstar 7K4000

This is the only 4 TB drive that we tested this year and frankly we were impressed with the performance offered. It sports a five-platter design and it performs fabulously across all benchmark tests. Sequential Read / Write (in MB/s): 167.91 / 153.42 and Assorted Read / Write (in MB/s): 162.47 / 138.31.

Seagate Momentus XT 750GB

Seagate Momentus XT offers an 8GB of SLC NAND memory which improves access times, reducing application load times for frequently used programs. Performance improvements over the older Momentus XT drive are significant. A hybrid drive worth recommending.



**Hitachi Deskstar
7K4000**
Price: ₹25,000



**Seagate
Momentus XT
750 GB**
Price: ₹10,000



**Intel Series
520 SSD**
Price: ₹19,500



**Corsair Force GS
240GB**
Price: ₹16,500

SSDs

Solid state drives are slowly but surely becoming more mainstream, thanks to prices coming down. The capacities have not increased exponentially but one major difference from last year when it came to SSD testing was that most of the drives sported the SandForce controllers. This is a far cry from the various controllers we saw last year. The differentiation happened with the kinds of memories that were used as the controllers were the same, except for the Zero1 Winner.

Zero1 Winner

Corsair Neutron GTX 240 GB

With the Neutron series, Corsair used a new controller from Link-A-Media - the LM87800. It offers great transfer speeds when compared with Intel Series 520 drive or Corsair Force GS 240 GB drive. Sequential write speeds touch 511 MB/s. random 512k writes were at 448 MB/s. Real life intra-drive speeds were over 160 MB/s. A 5-year warranty is an added plus.

Worthy Mentions

Intel Series 520 SSD 240 GB

It houses a SandForce SF 2281 controller. There are 16 x 16GB of 25nm Intel MLC NAND taking the total to 256 GB, but you will only get 240 GB as 16 GB is reserved for data parity, garbage collection and block replacement. Real-life sequential file-transfer tests easily crossed 290 MB/s.

Corsair Force GS 240 GB

It houses Toggle mode NAND modules and performs supremely when it comes to 4K Random Reads and Write speeds, which is important for daily use. The 4K speeds are almost double that of Intel Series 520, Corsair Force GT and Kingston HyperX 240GB SSDs.



▲ **SSDs:**
CORSAIR NEUTRON GTX 240 GB
Price: ₹18,200